



grow, and stake tall plants if necessary. Water and weed well while young. When established, avoid overwatering sprouting broccoli, to help it to overwinter.

HARVESTING

The central head of calabrese should be harvested before flower buds open. Then give the plant a mulch of compost to encourage it to produce a crop of side-shoots. Harvest spears of sprouting types before flower buds open, when they reach about 6 in (15 cm) in length. New spears will grow back and you may get a harvest for up to two months.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Broccoli is relatively problem-free, but rotating your crops will help to prevent persistent diseases such as clubroot from attacking. Cover plants with netting to deter pests such as birds and cabbage white butterflies.



Use netting as a barrier against pests.